

BUSN 6070 • Project Management & Consulting Methods • W25

Live Consulting Gig Project w/ BCLC

➔ Here is everything you ever wanted to know about the Live Consulting Gig Project for this class (but were afraid to ask) ...

Per the Course Outline, the Live Consulting Gig Project is worth 35% of your final grade in this course. It is a team-based grade based on the two shapes (triangle & square) and four colours (red, yellow, green, and blue) combinations used to group students. When I refer to “individual teams” I mean the small teams of 3-4 students (S02 red triangle, S03 green square, etc.). When I say “aggregate teams” I mean the larger teams of 12-16 students (S03 triangle team or S02 square team).

There are three parts to the project – they’re roughly equal in weight:

Process — we’ll be using an “agile” project management approach to this project. The artefacts from the individual teams (red triangle, green square, etc.) will be used to assess this part of the grade. This will count for 11% of your final grade. Details below.

Product — the aggregate teams will prepare a written report for our client; this is the final product. The usual parameters for a professional written report apply here — 12 pt. font, single spaced, APA style for citations & references. 1-page Executive Summary. Table of Contents. Page numbers ← that is all the really simple stuff. The hard part is the content — what goes into the report is up to the team. Students will ask “how many pages / words does it need to be” and the answer is “it depends”. Actually, the answer is “as many pages as it takes to make your arguments.” Roughly speaking, I think 40-ish pages would be an upper bound on the final deliverable — that would include all references, etc. This will count for 12% of your final grade. More details below – including commentary about GenAI.

Presentation — each aggregate team will present the findings from the report to our client in the last week of classes. Each team will have 75 minutes MAX for the presentation and Q&A. I would target a 25-30 minute presentation and then 20-30 minutes for Q&A — the additional time is in case there are lots of questions. A presentation is a *different* product from a report — don’t just throw your tables & charts & summarize paragraphs into bullet points and call it a presentation. Craft a story narrative from your report. Make your recommendation. Support it with evidence from your research. Practice / rehearse your delivery. Develop your team’s ideas visually to “wow” the client. This too will count for 12% of your final grade. More details below.

Product — here is what BCLC has asked us to help them with (already posted @ Moodle):

The online sports betting industry in B.C. is expanding aggressively, marketing excessively, and highly competitive. Assess the effectiveness of our online Sportsbook presence and develop innovative forward thinking product offerings and marketing strategies. How can we differentiate our sportsbook with original ideas, offerings, and public facing messaging?

The final product — the aggregate team's report — should address each of these areas:

Current Footprint Analysis: Assess our current online footprint by analyzing website traffic, app downloads and reviews, user engagement metrics, and player demographics (age and/or gender and/or ethnicity).

Competitive Analysis: Perform a competitive analysis to compare our online sportsbook presence and offerings with other illegal BC sportsbooks, identifying best practices, player needs, product offerings, player experiences, and areas for improvement.

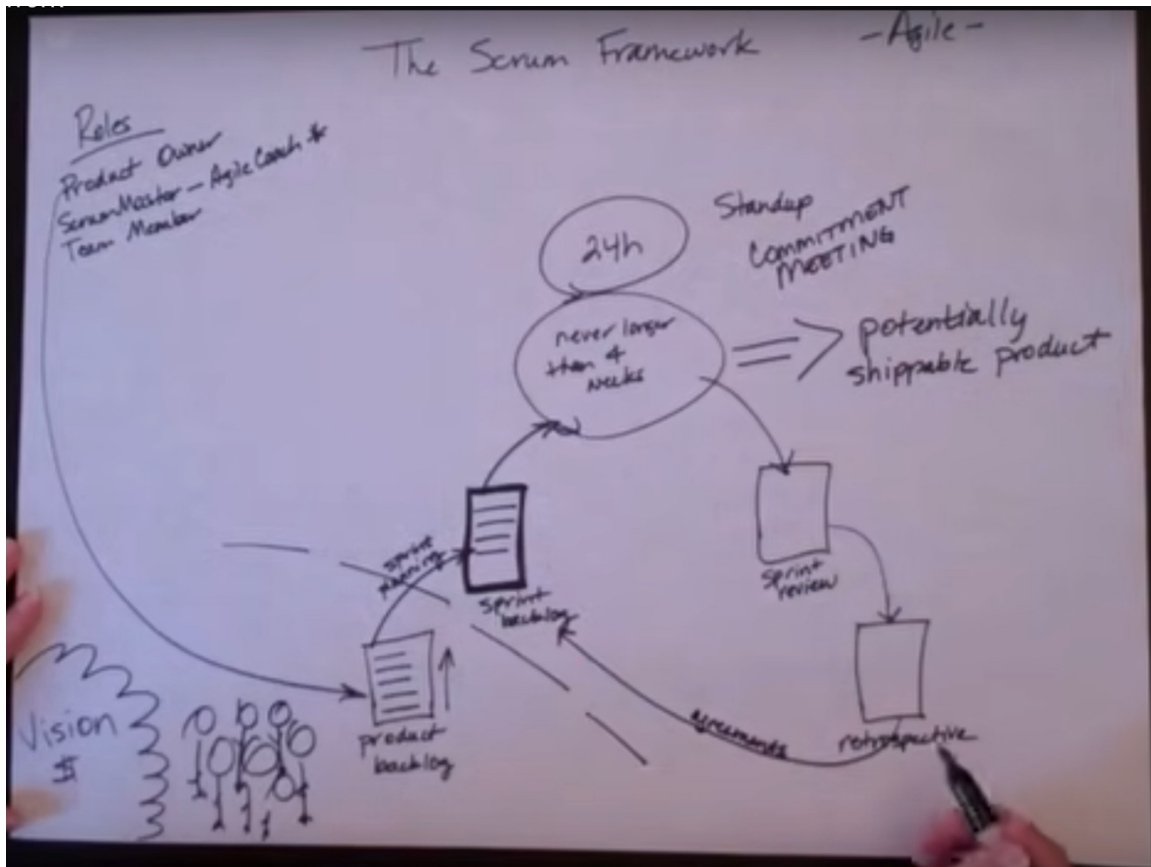
Product and Experience Offering Development: Identify innovative product offerings, player experiences, unique advantages to engage BC bettors with intent of increasing player market share.

★ **Market Strategy Development:** Create new marketing strategies (unique to the entire industry) to boost existing player engagement and increase B.C. player market share.

Implementation Plan: Develop a comprehensive plan based on your analysis and product findings/development for implementing the new marketing strategies. Include timelines, required resources and/or partners, potential challenges and risks, and risk mitigation strategies.

I've starred "Market Strategy Development" since that is the most important part of the final product. In order to do this you'll need to do the three items above it first. In previous iterations of this project presented in class, I proposed assigning individual teams to those areas. What we will do instead is have each individual team work on the first four items on their own and then use the aggregate team to bring everything together for the final report / implementation plan. How to do this? Let's get to **Process...**

Process — here is a screen grab from [The Scrum Framework](#) video on YouTube:



Scrum Framework (individual team) — these are sketches of the roles; you'll have to do some research on the internet to find out more 😊

Roles:

Product Owner — this will be a rotating role. The Product Owner creates the Product Backlog. They will prioritize the work for the sprint. For example, if the team has ten different marketing strategy ideas to pursue, the Product Owner will be in charge of prioritizing those ideas to a manageable number. The Product Owner will serve as the liaison to the larger aggregate team.

Scrum Master / Agile Coach — also a rotating role. The person in this role will do the sprint planning. They will lead the stand-up meetings during the sprint and facilitate the sprint retrospective at the end. They will monitor the progress against the goals the team set for the week.

Team Member — everyone on the team (even if you're in a rotating role) will contribute to the work. Please refer to the commentary in the Course Outline re: Teams & Teamwork under Classroom Policies.

Since there are three sprints and we have rotating roles — teams with three people means everyone will have a chance to experience both the Product Owner and Scrum Master role; teams with four people mean you might only get to experience one of these roles.

Artefacts:

Individual teams should create a **Team Agreement Canvas**; it will form part of the deliverables for the First Sprint. It doesn't need to be updated for each sprint.

Product Backlog — managed by the rotating Product Owner. Needs to be added / updated each iteration.

Sprint Backlog — managed by the rotating Scrum Master. Need a new one for each sprint.

Potentially Shippable Product — a standalone piece of the report. E.g., maybe the first sprint is to look at what a competitor is doing in this space – the PSP at the end of the sprint would be that final analysis and could be shared with the client if required. PSPs can be updated; for example, if the competitor analysis is complete from Sprint #1, but something changes in the marketplace (say) and it needs a refresh, then feel free to update it.

➔ The set of PSPs from the individual teams should be able to slot together into a Potentially Shippable Product for the aggregate team. For example, if all of the colour teams are working on a different competitor analysis, then the aggregate PSP would be that full section of the report (say).

Sprint Review / Retrospective — the reflection on the sprint. For this exercise, we will also use the Sprint Review as a “parking lot” for questions for the larger aggregate team to bring to our Project Sponsor (Aaron) during a weekly meeting. There should be a retrospective after each sprint.

Document Management — I have created a Microsoft Teams instance for us to use. Why? It is easier to use than Moodle and (hopefully) will allow our external clients to access the site to see the progress. The Teams instance is: **BUSN 6070 W25-O365** and the URL is:

[BUSN 6070 W25-O365 | General | Microsoft Teams](#)

The second reason is that inevitably some teams will use Google docs, others will use WhatsApp, others will use email, etc. and so on — all documents in one place please!

I have created a file structure that goes Section (02 or 03) > Shape (Square or Triangle) > Colour (Red, Yellow, Green, Blue). Right now, everything is open to everyone. In an ideal world, I would set-up role-based security where a student could only see files shared with their individual team (S02 Green Square say) and their aggregate team (S02 Square say) and nothing else. I trust you to not snoop on other team's work or sabotage their work.

That is the work to be done. **When** will it get done? Let's check the ol' calendar shall we?

Live Consulting Gig				
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Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday §02 • 14:30 • IB 1007	Thursday §03 • 11:30 • IB 1007	Friday
Week #8 • Mar. 3 rd BCLC Field Trip		Class Time for Sprint Planning	Class Time for Sprint Planning	Sprint #1 ready to go!
Week #9 • Mar. 10 th Sprint #1				First Sprint Complete
Week #10 • Mar. 17 th 🍀 Sprint #2 🍀				Second Sprint Complete
Week #11 • Mar. 24 th Final Sprint...				Final Sprint Complete
Week #12 • Mar. 31 st Presentation Prep...		§02 Presentations Square / Triangle	§03 Presentations Square / Triangle	Last Day of Classes (April 4 th)

In the second half of class on March 5th & 6th we'll use the time at the aggregate team level to **plan** for the first sprint which will be done at the individual team level. Use this time to sketch out the work for the next four weeks. Which individual teams will be responsible for which deliverables? How will it all come together?

➔ Note: I hope you can see some benefits to using this agile approach to this large project. Rather than have to craft a long report the night before it's due, your team(s) will create various bits of completed work across all of the weeks leading up to the completion. There should be less of a mad scramble at the end to get it all done since you won't be creating the pieces from scratch, but assembling the pieces built up over time!

Typical Sprint — here is how a typical sprint could flow:

Monday – the Product Owner reviews the Product Backlog, prioritizes the work, and works with the Scrum Master to create the Scrum Backlog. Stated another way, the individual team meets to plan to **plan** the work for the week 😊

Mid-Week – the individual team wraps up the work that was planned – a Potentially Shippable Product. It should be a complete, self-contained deliverable – maybe a couple of pages of a larger whole.

After class — the Scrum Team completes the Review / Retrospective. An important part of this work is determining what questions you would like to ask Aaron the next time you can. These questions will be pulled together at the aggregate team level.

Fridays — to be determined — but we would have a weekly Teams call with Aaron from BCLC to ask any clarifying questions that may have come up during the sprints. I would like to keep these manageable so I will limit participation to one representative from each of the aggregate teams (S02 square, S02 triangle, S03 square, and S03 triangle). I would also like to ensure we have rotating representation — so if you're part of S02 square and on a call one week, let another S02 square team member be a part of it the next time. Finally, ALL of the data from these meetings needs to be shared with all teams – so the people on the call should be ready to make notes and share them in the All Teams folder at Teams.

Weekend — take the weekend off, relax, cuz it all starts again on Monday 😊

A few other things — speak with one voice. The final product (report) should read like it was written by one person, even though it was written by a dozen or more in four teams across four weeks. Ditto for the final presentation.

IF you are going to use ChatGPT or other GenAI tool in the creation of your team's work **THEN** you need to include an appendix describing what tool(s) were used and how.

Research: looking for proper in-text citations and APA style. So something like this:
“According to Seal, et al (2022), young men are 25% more likely to bet on sports than young women” needs to have something like this...

Seal, E., Cardak, B. A., Nicholson, M., Donaldson, A., O'Halloran, P., Randle, E., & Staley, K. (2022). The gambling behaviour and attitudes to sports betting of sports fans. *Journal of Gambling Studies*, 38(4), 1371-1403

...in the References section. Links are fine, but you don't need to have links to everything.

If you are doing modelling state all of your assumptions and your values. E.g., “\$300M in sportsbook revenue would be required to achieve a net income of \$25M (assuming an average margin of 8%)” — that's fine. It is also easier to read than something like “\$320,512,821 in sportsbook revenue would be required to achieve a net income of \$25M (assuming an average margin of 7.8%)”.

Questions? Post 'em to Moodle...